```
'default' => env('DB_CONNECTION', 'mongodb'),
```

This tells Laravel to use the MongoDB connection when interacting with the database.

We need to activate MongoDB provider in the `bootstrap/providers.php` file. Open the `bootstrap/providers.php` file and add the following line to the `MongoDB\Laravel\MongoDBServiceProvider::clas` inside return array:

```
<?php

return [
    ...

    MongoDB\Laravel\MongoDBServiceProvider::class,
];
```

Save all the files and close them.

We need to refresh the configuration cache to apply the changes. Run the following command in your terminal:

```
php artisan config:cache
```

This command will clear the configuration cache and regenerate it with the new settings.

12.11.4.5 Step 5: Create Blog Model

We will create a `Blog` model to interact with the `blogs` collection in MongoDB. Run the following command to create the model:

```
php artisan make:model Blog
```

Edit `app/Models/Blog.php`:

```
<?php

namespace App\Models;

use MongoDB\Laravel\Eloquent\Model;

class Blog extends Model
{
    protected $connection = 'mongodb';
    protected $collection = 'blogs';

    protected $fillable = ['title', 'content', 'comments'];
```